



Mauritius Examinations Syndicate

PSAC 2025

Mathematics

Subject code: P120

Examiners' Report

Introduction

The 2025 PSAC Mathematics assessment was meant to measure the extent to which learners have developed the mathematical proficiencies and competencies defined in the National Curriculum Framework (NCF) and the Teaching and Learning Syllabus Grade 1 - 6 (MIE, 2017).

Candidates are assessed on three Assessment Objectives (AOs) as defined in the Annual Programme for PSAC.

AO1: Knowledge and Comprehension (40%)

Questions assessing 'Knowledge and Comprehension' aim at showing candidates' ability to, 'recall specific mathematical facts, concepts, rules and formulae; represent simple mathematical statements or information; perform simple mathematical operations and routine procedures.'

AO2: Application (40%)

Questions assessing 'Application' aim at assessing candidates' ability to, 'identify and apply mathematical concepts, rules and formulae, skills and techniques to solve familiar problems in Mathematics'

AO3: Analysis (20%)

Questions assessing 'Analysis' aim at indicating candidate's ability to 'break down and interpret multi-faceted information and data into their component parts; recognise and use unstated mathematical assumptions in problem solving; formulate appropriate strategies to solve non-routine problems'.

General Comments

The 2025 PSAC Mathematics assessment revealed encouraging outcomes overall. The proportion of candidates achieving Grade 5 or better rose slightly compared to the previous year, moving from 78.60% in 2024 to 79.83% in 2025. Candidates generally demonstrated strong performance on questions that tested knowledge and comprehension. However, they encountered greater difficulty with items requiring higher-order thinking skills. While many students performed commendably, a portion of the cohort showed limited progress and fell short of the expected standard at this level.

Several factors contributed to weaker performance among some candidates:

- Gaps in foundational mathematical skills
- Inability to recall multiplication tables, resulting in slow or inaccurate calculations
- Reliance on surface-level teaching and learning approaches
- Mechanical application of procedures without conceptual understanding
- Challenges in logical reasoning and problem-solving
- Lack of confidence when tackling complex problems
- Low motivation levels
- Difficulties with English comprehension
- Weak presentation skills, leading to unclear communication of reasoning and loss of marks on intermediate steps

A recurring issue was the tendency to provide mechanical responses. Many candidates applied memorised procedures without grasping the underlying concepts, which left them unable to adapt when questions were phrased differently or required a slight variation in approach. This often led to incorrect answers despite familiarity with the basic methods.

Multi-step problems posed a particular challenge. These questions demand planning, strategy, and confidence in breaking tasks into manageable steps. Many candidates appeared overwhelmed by their complexity, resulting in incomplete or inaccurate solutions even when they understood individual concepts. Such problems are crucial for nurturing mathematical reasoning, decision-making, and problem-solving skills, yet many students struggled to engage with them effectively.

Language barriers also played a role. Candidates who struggled with English comprehension often found it difficult to interpret word problems accurately. To address this, educators should integrate language development into mathematics teaching—focusing on command verbs, reading comprehension exercises, and glossaries of key mathematical terms to strengthen students' ability to interpret and respond to exam questions.

Presentation of work remains another area for improvement. Many candidates failed to show their reasoning clearly, which prevented examiners from awarding partial credit.

Students should be encouraged to write legibly, present their steps systematically, and communicate their thought process effectively to secure full marks.

Like in previous years, fluency with multiplication tables was another weakness. Without automatic recall of multiplication facts, students relied on inefficient counting strategies, which slowed their calculations and increased errors. Strengthening recall of multiplication facts would improve confidence, accuracy, and recognition of number patterns, factors, and multiples.

To better prepare students for mathematics examinations, educators should adopt structured strategies that build both confidence and competence. Regular practice with past papers and sample questions helps students become familiar with exam formats and the phrasing of questions. Educators should emphasise time management by encouraging students to allocate time proportionally across the whole paper and avoid spending too much time on a single problem. Training students to read questions carefully, underline key words, and plan their approach before attempting solutions can reduce careless mistakes. Incorporating mock exams under timed conditions allows learners to experience the pressure of real assessments and develop resilience. Finally, encouraging reflective review—where students analyse errors, identify misconceptions, and refine their strategies—ensures that preparation is not only about practice but also about growth in understanding and problem-solving ability.

Comments on specific questions

Very short answer questions/Short answer questions

Questions 1–18 were designed to assess candidates' understanding and application of basic mathematical operations, rules, and facts. Overall, the majority of candidates performed well across these questions. However, some candidates encountered difficulties with specific questions, notably Questions 3, 8, 13, and 17(a) and 18.

Question 1

$$\begin{array}{r} 543 \\ + \\ 201 \\ \hline \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Most candidates answered correctly.

(Ans: 744)

Question 2

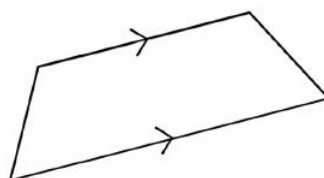
$$\begin{array}{r} 857 \\ - \\ 326 \\ \hline \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Most candidates answered correctly.

(Ans: 531)

Question 3

What is the special name given to the quadrilateral shown?



A significant number of candidates were unable to correctly identify the trapezium, with many confusing it for a parallelogram. The most frequent incorrect response was “parallelogram.” In addition, several candidates struggled with spelling the word “trapezium,” producing variations such as Trapizium, Trappigeon, and Trapizzum. This suggests both a lack of familiarity with the shape itself and insufficient practice in using the correct mathematical terminology. Candidates should be reminded that a trapezium has one pair of parallel lines, whereas a parallelogram has two pairs of parallel lines. Reinforcing this distinction will help reduce conceptual confusion and improve accuracy in future assessments. (Ans: *trapezium*)

Question 4

$$\begin{array}{r} 602 \\ \times 4 \\ \hline \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Most candidates answered correctly.

(Ans: 2408)

Question 5

Reduce $\frac{10}{25}$ to its **lowest term**.

Many candidates answered this question correctly. However, a few candidates lacked fluency in simplification techniques and were unsuccessful in reducing the given fraction to its lowest terms.

(Ans: $\frac{2}{5}$)

Question 6

Convert 6 km into metres.

Around 65% of candidates answered correctly. The remaining candidates struggled with the conversion from kilometres to metres. The most common mistake was giving 600 m as the final answer, due to the incorrect assumption that 1 km = 100 m.

(Ans: 6000)

Question 7

In words	In figures
Example: Five hundred and fifty eight	558
(a) Four hundred and sixty nine	_____
(b) _____ _____	1342

- (a) Most candidates successfully wrote four hundred and sixty-nine in figures
(Ans: 469).
- (b) Approximately 25% of candidates experienced difficulty writing the number 1342 in words. The most common errors involved spelling “forty” incorrectly, with variants such as fourty and fouty. In addition, some candidates incorrectly used plural forms, writing thousands instead of thousand and hundreds instead of hundred.

Frequent incorrect responses included:

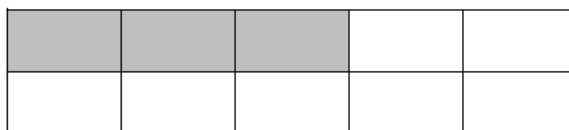
- One thousand and three hundred and fourty two
- One thousand three hundreds and fouty two

This highlights the need for greater emphasis on accurate spelling of number words and correct use of singular forms when expressing place values.

(Ans: one thousand three hundred and forty-two)

Question 8

What fraction of the diagram is **not** shaded?



Performance in this question was good. Candidates were expected to write the fraction representing the unshaded part of the diagram. However, many gave the fraction for the shaded part instead. This error highlights the importance of carefully reading and interpreting the question before attempting an answer. Candidates must be encouraged to take time to understand what is being asked, as misinterpretation often leads to avoidable mistakes.

(Ans: $\frac{7}{10}$)

Question 9

$$\begin{array}{r} 3 \overline{) 1536} \\ \underline{} \end{array}$$

Most candidates were successful in dividing $1536 \div 3$. This demonstrates a generally sound grasp of basic division skills and number operations. The majority were able to apply the procedure accurately and arrive at the correct answer, reflecting

confidence in handling straightforward calculations.

(Ans: 512)

Question 10

$$\frac{4}{13} + \frac{5}{13}$$

Most candidates answered correctly.

(Ans: $\frac{9}{13}$)

Question 11

Find the **value** of 7^2 .

Most candidates successfully obtained the correct answer of 49. A minority, however, demonstrated misconceptions such as:

- incorrectly expressed 7^2 as 7×2 , thereby reaching 14 as final answer,

- leaving their response in expanded form as 7×7 without evaluating it. The question explicitly required the numerical value, not the expression.

Candidates should be reminded to carefully read instructions and ensure they provide the final evaluated answer rather than leaving responses in working form. Educators may wish to emphasize the importance of distinguishing between expanded notation and the required simplified/numerical value in practice exercises.

(Ans: 49)

Question 12

Tick (✓) the box showing the correct answer.

An **obtuse** angle is

less than 90°	☐
equal to 180°	☐
between 90° and 180°	☐
between 180° and 360°	☐

6 out of 10 candidates correctly identified that an obtuse angle lies between 90° and 180° . This shows a sound understanding of the basic definition. Some candidates ticked two answers, suggesting uncertainty about the concept while others chose the incorrect option “between 180° and 360° ”, indicating confusion between obtuse and reflex angles.

(Ans: between 90° and 180°)

Question 13

Find the Highest Common Factor (H.C.F.) of 10 and 15.

About 60% of candidates correctly determined the H.C.F., showing competence

in factorisation methods. However, a significant proportion confused H.C.F. with L.C.M., often calculating the L.C.M. instead. While most candidates could list factors or perform prime factorisation for at least one of the numbers, their difficulty lay in distinguishing between multiples and factors. This indicates that the conceptual difference between H.C.F. and L.C.M. has not been fully mastered.

Educators should reinforce the distinction between factors (numbers that divide exactly) and multiples (products obtained by multiplying). Practical exercises comparing H.C.F. and L.C.M. side by side can help clarify the difference. Using visual aids such as factor trees, or number line representations may strengthen conceptual understanding.

(Ans: 5)

Question 14

Arrange the following numbers in **ascending order**.

9403 , 4903 , 3409 , 3490

Most candidates correctly arranged the numbers in ascending order, demonstrating a clear understanding of the requirement. A handful, however, wrote the numbers in descending order instead, which suggests either a misinterpretation of the instruction or a lack of attention to detail. Candidates should be encouraged to carefully read the wording of questions, especially when tasks involve ordering or sequencing.

(Ans: 3409, 3490, 4903, 9403)

Question 15

Calculate angle x .



Many candidates correctly identified that the two angles were supplementary. The most common method used was subtracting 147° from 180° ($180^\circ - 147^\circ$) to find the missing angle. A small number of candidates also used an alternative approach, $360^\circ - 180^\circ - 147^\circ$, which also led to the correct result.

Most candidates were awarded partial marks for demonstrating a correct method, even if minor arithmetic errors occurred. (Ans: 33)

Question 16

Express $\frac{17}{7}$ as a mixed number.

Around 70% of the candidates correctly converted the improper fraction to a mixed number. A small number were able to divide 17 by 7 and obtained 2 remainder 3; however, they were unable to express the result correctly as a mixed number. The incorrect form $3 \frac{2}{7}$ was commonly seen, indicating confusion in placing the whole number and the remainder. (Ans: $2 \frac{3}{7}$)

Question 17

(a) Calculate 0.3×1.5

(b) Calculate $10.4 \div 2$

Candidates performed much better in part(b) than in part(a). Many candidates experienced difficulty when multiplying two decimal numbers, particularly in determining the correct placement of the decimal point. Incorrect answers such as 4.5 or 45 were frequently seen, indicating a lack of understanding of place value in decimal multiplication. (Ans: (a) 0.45 (b) 5.2)

Question 18

What is the place value of 2 in 53 264?

Performance on this question was generally poor. Many candidates appeared to confuse the terms *value* and *place value*, often stating the value of the digit instead of its place value. For example, while the value of 2 in the given number is 200, its place value should be expressed as **2 hundreds**. The most common wrong answers were 200 or 2 hundred. Around 50% of the candidates scoring above 90 did not earn the mark in this question.

(Ans: 2 hundreds)

Multiple Choice Questions

Questions 19 - 28

The Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs) were generally well-answered with the exception of questions 20, 23 and 24. While the MCQs are considered 'easy' and test mostly basic knowledge candidates have to be careful while answering this type of question. Some issues noted in scripts during the marking exercise and statistics analyses are listed below:

- Candidates did not circle answers even if their workings are seen to be correct.
 - A few candidates made their choices by ticking or crossing out or underlining the correct answer.
 - In a few scripts it was noted that candidates circled 2 answers instead of one.
 - Some candidates provided correct workings but did not circle their answer.
- Candidates should be reminded to circle their answer to make their choice clear.

Question 19

What is the Least Common Multiple (L.C.M.) of 6 and 8?

- A 6
- B 8
- C 12
- D 24

Performance of candidates in this question was good. A qualitative analysis from the marking exercise, showed that candidates could not discern between finding the L.C.M. and the H.C.F.

(Ans: D)

Question 20

Which of these numbers is composite?

- A 17
- B 27
- C 37
- D 47

Many candidates found it challenging to identify a composite number from the given list. There was evident confusion between the definitions of prime and composite numbers, with some candidates demonstrating a lack of understanding of the distinguishing characteristics of each.

(Ans: B)

Question 21

$\frac{4}{5}$ expressed as a percentage is

- A 40 %
- B 50 %
- C 60 %
- D 80 %

Performance was fair in this question

Option A was the most common distractor chosen.

(Ans: D)

Question 22

Which number is 1000 more than 39 200?

- A 38 200
- B 39 300
- C 40 200
- D 49 200

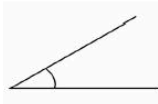
This question was well answered by most candidates.

(Ans: C)

Question 23

Which of the following is a reflex angle?

A



B



C



D



Overall performance on this question was good, with slightly around 60% of the candidates selecting the correct answer. However, a significant proportion of candidates struggled to identify the reflex angle, often confusing it with an obtuse angle. This indicates a conceptual weakness in distinguishing between angle types, particularly those greater than 180°. The most common distractor was option C, suggesting that many candidates found this alternative plausible and highlighting the need for clearer teaching and practice in recognizing reflex angles.

(Ans: B)

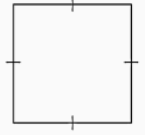
Question 24

Which of the following shapes is a **regular quadrilateral**?

A 

B 

C 

D 

Performance on this question quite poor. Less than half of the candidates chose the correct option. While some candidates demonstrated sound understanding, a notable number did not appear to be familiar with the term regular quadrilateral and consequently selected incorrect responses. This highlights a gap in knowledge of geometric terminology. Option C (rectangle) proved to be a strong distractor, suggesting that many candidates associated “regular” with common shapes rather than recognizing the requirement for equal sides and angles. This misconception indicates the need for greater emphasis on precise

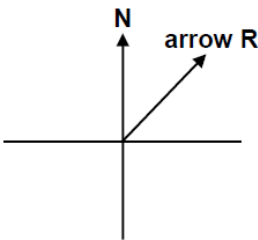
definitions and properties of regular polygons.

(Ans: D)

Question 25

In which direction is **arrow R** pointing?

A North East
B North West
C North
D West



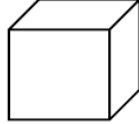
Performance in this question was quite good, with a large number of candidates able to solve the problem and select the correct answer. However, a notable proportion chose option B, which indicates confusion between the directions north-east and north-west. This suggests that

while many candidates demonstrated sound spatial reasoning, some lacked precision in distinguishing between compass points, highlighting a need for reinforcement of directional terminology and orientation skills. (Ans: A)

Question 26

The total surface area of a cube is 54 cm^2 . Find the area of **one** face.

- A 3
- B 9
- C 18
- D 27



Many candidates were able to select the correct option, showing a good level of understanding overall. However, a significant number calculated the length of one edge instead of the area of one face, which led them to choose the wrong response. Consequently, Option A emerged as a strong distractor. This

error highlights a common misconception between linear and area measures, suggesting that candidates need more practice in distinguishing between dimensions when solving geometry problems. (*Ans: B*)

Question 27

$$(3 \times 10) + (5 \times 100) + (2 \times 1) + (6 \times 1000) =$$

- A 6523
- B 6325
- C 6532
- D 6253

Most candidates chose the correct option.

(*Ans: C*)

Question 28

Jasmine has twenty-five stickers. She gives some of her stickers to her friend.

Jasmine now has sixteen **left**.

How many stickers has she given to her friend?

- A 9
- B 11
- C 16
- D 25

This question was mostly well answered, with many students demonstrating sound understanding. However, candidates with language difficulties struggled to interpret the requirements of the word problem and were therefore unable to provide the correct solution. (*Ans: A*)

Question 29

Samuel has 84 paper clips. Alex has **4 times** as many paper clips as Samuel.

How many paper clips does Alex have?

Performance in this question was relatively good, with many candidates correctly identifying multiplication as the required operation and successfully reaching the answer of 336. However, a number of candidates misinterpreted the problem and divided 84 by 4 instead, revealing a weakness in distinguishing between multiplication and division contexts. In some cases, candidates recognized that multiplication was necessary but lacked fluency in carrying it out, resulting in partial credit. A positive observation was that repetitive addition was often used effectively, demonstrating conceptual understanding and flexibility in problem-solving. Overall, while most candidates showed competence, greater emphasis on accurate problem interpretation and multiplication skills would strengthen performance. (Ans: 336)

Question 30

Given that $421 \times 534 = 224\,814$, use mental calculation to write down the missing numbers in the empty boxes below:

(a) $224\,814 \div 421 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

(b) $\underline{\hspace{2cm}} \times 534 = 224\,814 + 534$

(c) $53.4 \times 4.21 = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

Candidates are generally familiar with this type of question, as it frequently appears in the PSAC Mathematics assessment. While most candidates were able to attempt part (a) and (c) successfully, a significant number encountered difficulties in part (b) indicating that candidates found this section especially challenging without written workings. Multiplying two decimal numbers proved problematic for many, as they struggled with correctly placing the decimal point, highlighting a need for stronger conceptual understanding and practice in

decimal operations. Many resorted to written calculations despite instructions to use mental methods, which suggests a lack of confidence or fluency in mental arithmetic.

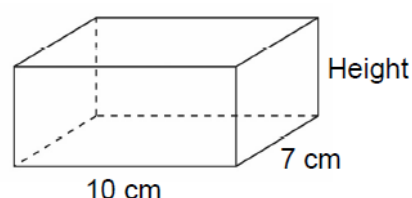
(Ans: (a) 534 (b) 422 (c) 224.814)

Question 31

A cuboid has a volume of 350 cm^3 .

The cuboid has length 10 cm and width 7 cm.

Calculate the **height** of the cuboid.



Performance in this question was quite good, with around 60% candidates able to give the correct answer. Candidates were expected to determine the height of a cuboid when given its volume, length, and breadth, which required manipulation of the formula for volume $V = L \times B \times H$. Although most candidates knew the correct formula, full credit was often lost due to errors such as using the wrong expression like writing height as $\frac{L \times W}{V}$ instead of $\frac{V}{L \times W}$ or confusing perimeter with volume. In several cases, candidates began calculations (for example, $7 \times 10 = 70$) but did not complete the process, leaving their answers unfinished. A lack of fluency in multiplication and division was also evident, suggesting that while conceptual knowledge of the formula was present, computational skills and confidence in carrying through the operations need further reinforcement.

(Ans: 5)

Question 32

A headmaster buys packets of erasers to distribute among his 202 pupils at school.

Each packet contains exactly 16 erasers.

Find the **smallest** number of packets of erasers that the headmaster needs to buy.

This question proved challenging for many candidates. While many recognised the need to divide 202 by 16, yielding $12\frac{5}{8}$, some attempted repeated subtraction to determine the smallest number of packets of erasers. A common error was giving $12\frac{5}{8}$ as the final answer

instead of 13, as candidates did not realize that the number of packets must be expressed as the next whole number. Others struggled with long division, leading to computational mistakes, while a considerable number multiplied 202 by 16, showing a fundamental misunderstanding of the problem.

These errors highlight weaknesses in interpreting fractional results in practical contexts, applying division accurately, and correctly identifying the required operation. To address these issues, candidates should strengthen their conceptual understanding of whole-number solutions in real-world scenarios, practice division skills to build fluency, and improve problem analysis to distinguish between multiplication and division requirements. (Ans:13)

Question 33

A list of numbers is given below.

90	2400	170	83
602	125	1934	

From the list, write down a number which is

- (a) divisible by 100,
- (b) less than (10×13) and is a multiple of 10.

Part(a)

Most candidates were able to correctly identify 2400 (as it is divisible by 100) from the given list. However, some candidates incorrectly presented their answer as $2400 \div 100 = 24$, for which they were penalised. This error suggests that while candidates recognized divisibility, they misunderstood the requirement to state the actual number from the list rather than the quotient.

(Ans:2400)

Part(b)

Half of the candidates did not understand the requirements of the question, and this led to a range of incorrect responses.

A common wrong answer was 130, derived from calculating 10×30 , even though 130 was not in the given list. In doing so, candidates overlooked the fact that the required number had to be both a multiple of 10 and less than 130. This indicates that some candidates rushed into calculations without carefully considering the conditions stated in the question.

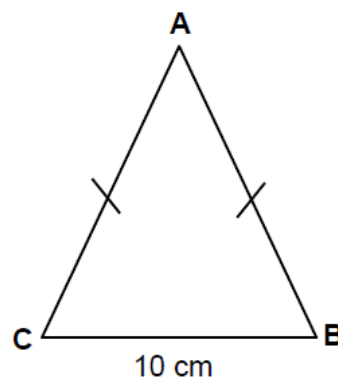
To improve performance, candidates should be encouraged to read and fully understand the requirements before attempting their answers.

(Ans:90)

Question 34

Triangle **ABC** is isosceles where **AB = AC**.

The perimeter of triangle **ABC** is 40 cm.



If the length of **BC** = 10 cm, find the length of **AC**.

Many candidates demonstrated a sound understanding of perimeter and were able to determine the length of AC correctly. A number of candidates even carried out the calculation mentally, showing confidence in their approach.

However, some candidates began with the incorrect assumption that triangle ABC was equilateral rather than isosceles, leading them to conclude that $AC = 10$ cm. This error highlights a lack of recognition and recall of the properties of an isosceles triangle.

In addition, a few candidates attempted to subtract 10 cm from the given perimeter of 40 cm but did not progress further to calculate the required length of AC. This suggests partial understanding of the process but difficulty in completing the reasoning to its conclusion.

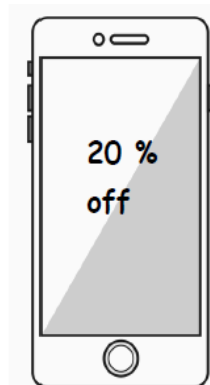
(Ans: 15)

Question 35

During a sale, all prices are **reduced** by 20%.

Mila buys a mobile phone at the reduced price of Rs 6480.

Calculate the **original** price of the mobile phone.



Despite being a traditional question involving percentage decrease and reverse calculations, 7 out of 10 candidates were unsuccessful in arriving at the correct solution. This was one of the least well-answered questions. The main difficulty appeared to be a lack of understanding that Rs 6480 represented the **decreased** price of the mobile phone, corresponding 80% of the original price.

A common incorrect approach taken by candidates was to assume that Rs 6480 represented 100%. Many worked through the problem as follows:

$$100\% = \text{Rs } 6480$$

$$20\% = 20\% \text{ of } 6480 = \text{Rs } 1296$$

$$\text{Original Price} = \text{Rs } 6480 + \text{Rs } 1296 = \textbf{Rs } 7776$$

This method reflects a fundamental misunderstanding of percentage relationships in reverse percentage problems.

Another frequent error was applying the formula incorrectly as: $(80 / 100) \times 6480$, further reinforcing the misconception that Rs 6480 was the original price rather than the decreased amount.

Educators are advised to:

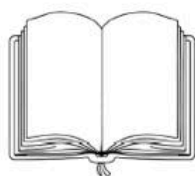
- Reinforce the concept that in reverse percentage problems, the given value often represents a reduced or increased percentage of the original, not the full 100%.

- Use visual aids (such as bar models or tables) to illustrate how percentages relate to the original value, helping students see the difference between original prices and decreased or increased prices.
- Provide practice questions where the given value corresponds to different percentages (e.g., 70%, 85%) to strengthen flexibility in reasoning.
- Encourage step-by-step working rather than mental shortcuts, so candidates clearly identify what percentage the given value represents before proceeding.
- Highlight common misconceptions—such as assuming the given value equals 100%—and address them explicitly during instruction.

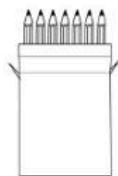
(Ans: 8100)

Question 36

The prices of a few articles sold in a supermarket are given below.



Book
Rs 150



Packet of pencils
Rs 125.30



Pack of copybooks
Rs 210

- Find the cost of 2 packets of pencils.
- Prisca buys a pack of copybooks, a book and 2 packets of pencils.
She pays using **two** 500-rupee notes.

How much change does she receive?

Part(a)

Many candidates successfully calculated the cost of two packets of pencils, either through multiplication or repeated addition. This demonstrates confidence in applying basic arithmetic operations.

However, some candidates ignored the decimal part and treated the price as Rs 125 instead of Rs 125.30. This approach suggests limited confidence in working with decimals,

and for convenience, they rounded down to a whole number. Such simplification alters the level of difficulty of the question and prevents candidates from obtaining full credit.

(Ans: 250.60)

Part(b)

This part proved to be more challenging for many candidates. Only around 35% of the candidates reached the correct answer.

Common mistakes included:

1. Considering only two articles instead of three, due to misinterpretation of the question, negligence, or avoidance of prices expressed in decimals.
2. Treating the payment as a single Rs 500 note instead of two Rs 500 notes, and consequently subtracting the total price of the articles from Rs 500 rather than Rs 1000, which lowered the level of difficulty.
3. Making arithmetic errors.

Educators are advised to:

- Emphasise careful reading of questions to avoid misinterpretation.
- Reinforce confidence in handling decimals through regular practice.
- Use practical money-based examples to strengthen understanding of transactions.
- Encourage accuracy and checking of arithmetic steps to reduce careless mistakes.

(Ans: 389.40)

Question 37

1 Pound Sterling (£) = Rs 60

1 Euro (€) = Rs 55

(a) Misha has € 650. She exchanges all her money into rupees.

How much money does Misha get in **rupees**?

(b) After spending Rs 28550, Misha exchanges her remaining money into **Pound Sterling (£)**.

How much does she receive in **Pound Sterling (£)**?

Many candidates were familiar with this type of question and performed well, while others scored only partial marks. A common error was the swapping of values (between 60 and 55), which suggests uncertainty in handling foreign currency conversions.

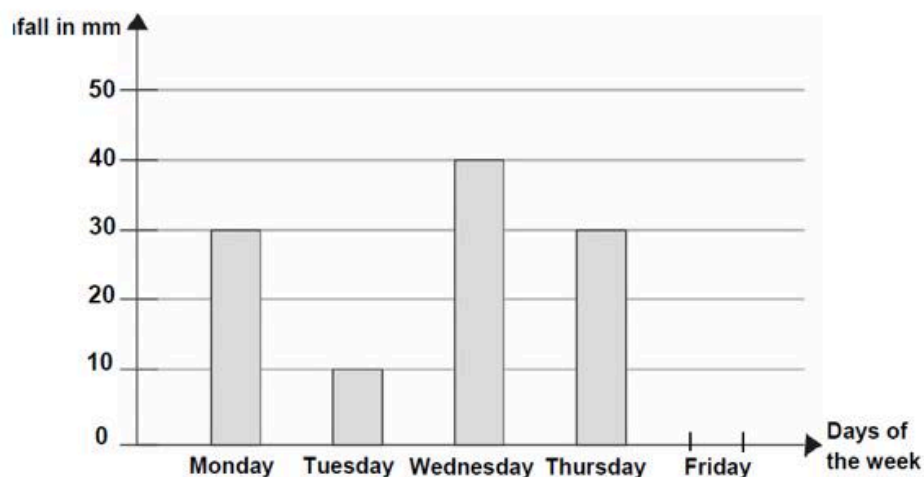
In part (a), arithmetic errors were frequently noted, particularly when multiplying 650 by 55. In part (b), candidates were expected to perform long division ($7200 \div 60$), but many struggled to reach the correct answer. These difficulties highlight a lack of confidence in both currency conversion and basic arithmetic operations. (*Ans: (a) 35750 (b) 120*)

Educators are advised to:

- Reinforce careful reading of numerical values to avoid swapping or misinterpretation.
- Provide more practice with foreign currency conversions to build confidence.
- Strengthen arithmetic fluency, especially multiplication and long division.
- Encourage step-by-step working to reduce careless mistakes and improve accuracy.

Question 38

The bar chart below shows the amount of rainfall recorded over 5 consecutive days of a week. The information for Friday is missing.



- If the total rainfall for the week was 120 mm, how much rainfall was recorded on Friday?
- Complete the bar chart to illustrate the amount of rainfall recorded on Friday.
- On which day was the **greatest** amount of rainfall recorded?
- The information shown in the bar chart is represented on a pie chart.
Calculate the **angle** which represents the rainfall recorded on Thursday.

Overall performance in this question was generally good except for part(d). Candidate performance in parts (a), (b) and (c) of this question was generally strong. Approximately 8 out of 10 candidates were able to successfully answer part (a). Candidates were able to interpret the bar chart in parts (b) and (c), demonstrating a sound understanding of bar charts.

In part(d) candidates were expected to interpret the information given in the bar chart and find the angle that the amount of rainfall recorded on Thursday would be in a pie chart. Many candidates struggled and common mistakes noted were:

- Writing $\frac{30}{120} \times 100$ or $\frac{30}{360} \times 100$ instead of $\frac{30}{120} \times 360$
- Misreading data from the bar chart

Many blank spaces were noted for part(d), indicating uncertainty or lack of confidence in approaching the problem. Only 1 out of 4 candidates reached the correct answer for part(d).

(Ans: (a) 10 (b) correctly drawn bar of 10 mm (c) Wednesday (d) 90)

Question 39

The table shows the opening hours of a zoo.

Monday to Friday	Saturday and Sunday
10 a.m. to 5 p.m.	9.30 a.m. to 6 p.m.

(a) At what time does the zoo close on Tuesdays?

(b) For how long is the zoo open on Saturdays?

Some candidates were unable to differentiate between opening and closing times, particularly due to language difficulties.

Part (a)

Most candidates successfully attempted this part and correctly interpreted the table to identify the closing time of the zoo on Tuesdays.

Part (b)

This part proved more challenging. Candidates were required to calculate the opening hours on Saturdays by converting 6 p.m. into the 24-hour clock format. Many failed to do so, instead they wrote 06:00 – 09:30, which prevented them from reaching the correct answer. Subtraction of time also proved difficult for many candidates.

Educators are encouraged to:

- Reinforce the distinction between opening and closing times through clear examples.
- Provide practice in converting between 12-hour and 24-hour clock formats.
- Strengthen skills in subtracting times accurately.
- Use real-life contexts (e.g., timetables, schedules) to build confidence in interpreting time-related information. (Ans: (a) 5 p.m. (b) 8 h 30 minutes)

Question 40

The ticket prices for different age groups at a recreational park are given below:

Age (Years)	4 or less	5 to 15	16 to 60	61 or more
Price (Rs)	Free	250	300	275

Brinda goes to the recreational park with her husband, her father and her two children, Anna and Jessie.

- Brinda is 41 years old.
- Her husband is 45 years old.
- Her father is 63 years old.
- Anna and Jessie are 4 and 13 years old respectively.

- (a) How much will Brinda have to pay for the **whole** family to visit the recreational park?
- (b) Jessie needs to be at least 130 cm tall to be allowed on the Monkey Swing.

Jessie is $1\frac{1}{2}$ m tall.

- (i) Can Jessie go on the Monkey Swing?

Tick (✓) the box.

Yes ☐ No ☐

- (ii) Give a reason for your answer.

This multi-faceted question required candidates to interpret information from a table and apply higher-order thinking and mathematical skills. Very few candidates achieved full marks, indicating widespread difficulty with both comprehension and justification.

Part (a)

Many candidates struggled to interpret the information from the table accurately. A frequent error was adding only three entries (e.g., $300 + 275 + 250$) instead of correctly including all four ticket prices ($300 + 300 + 275 + 250$). In some cases, candidates mistakenly added the ages of family members rather than the ticket costs, which highlights a lack of careful reading and data selection. These mistakes suggest that candidates need more practice in distinguishing between different types of numerical information presented in tables. The

correct total was 1125, and teachers should emphasize systematic approaches to extracting and applying relevant values when working with structured data.

(Ans:1125)

Part (b)

In this section, many candidates correctly identified that Jessie could go on the monkey swing by ticking “Yes,” but they often failed to provide a clear justification. A common error was miscalculating the conversion of $1\frac{1}{2}$ m, with some incorrectly equating it to 120 cm instead of 150 cm, which led to wrong comparisons against the 130 cm requirement. While some candidates reached the right conclusion, their reasoning lacked precision and clarity. Teachers should reinforce accurate unit conversions and train candidates to justify answers concisely by directly comparing the relevant values.

(Ans: (i) yes (ii) Jessie is 150 cm and she needs to be above 130 cm)

Question 41

- (a) Mike cycles from Town A to Town B. He leaves Town A at 10 15.
His journey takes 2 hours 50 minutes.
At what time does he reach Town B?
- (b) The distance from Town A to Town B is 34 km.
Calculate Mike’s average speed.

Performance in this question was satisfactory in general.

Part (a)

Most candidates demonstrated familiarity with the speed formula and understood that they needed to add 10.15 to 2 hours 50 minutes to determine the time at which Mike reached town B. However, only half of the candidates reached the correct final answer. Many struggled to express their final answers in the correct standard time format, often writing responses such as 12:65 or 13:5 instead of the expected 13:05. This indicates a weakness in candidates’ ability to handle time notation accurately. In addition, a few candidates confused the duration

of the journey with the actual arrival time, further highlighting the need for practice in distinguishing between elapsed time and clock time. Teachers should reinforce the conventions of time representation and provide exercises that require candidates to convert and present time correctly in standard form. (Ans: 13:05)

Part(b)

Around 20% of candidates successfully answered this part. Candidates were expected to convert 2 hours 50 minutes into hours and then use this value to calculate the average speed. While most knew the procedure, many struggled with the conversion step and therefore could not proceed to the correct answer. A few candidates incorrectly used the arrival time obtained in Part (a) instead of the journey duration when calculating average speed, which indicates confusion between different aspects of time measurement. Teachers should emphasize accurate conversion of mixed units into hours and ensure candidates understand the distinction between journey duration and arrival time when applying the speed formula.

(Ans: 12)

Question 42

Part (a)

(a) Write down a fraction equivalent to $\frac{4}{5}$.

Most candidates were able to write a fraction equivalent to $\frac{4}{5}$, showing basic familiarity with the concept. However, a significant number did not fully understand the meaning of “equivalent fraction” and instead attempted to convert the given fraction into a decimal or percentage. This indicates a conceptual gap between recognising equivalent forms of fractions and understanding how they differ from other representations. Educators should emphasize the distinction between equivalent fractions and other numerical forms, providing practice in generating multiple equivalent fractions through multiplication or division of numerator and denominator by the same integer.

(Ans: $\frac{8}{10}$ or equivalent)

Part (b)

(b) The volumes of water contained in bottles A, B, C and D are given below.



$\frac{17}{20}$ litre



$\frac{4}{5}$ litre



$\frac{7}{10}$ litre



$\frac{19}{40}$ litre

- (i) Which bottle has the **greatest** volume of water?
- (ii) What is the **total** amount of water contained in bottles **B** and **C**?

Give your answer in mL.

Part b(i):

This question proved demanding for the majority of candidates. Many struggled to devise a systematic strategy for identifying which bottle contained the greatest volume of water. A correct approach required either expressing all fractions with a common denominator for direct comparison, or converting the given quantities into a consistent unit (mL or cL). A number of candidates, however, gave “17/20” as their final answer rather than correctly identifying Bottle A, suggesting that they focused on the numerical fraction rather than the contextual requirement of naming the bottle.

(Ans: Bottle A)

Part b(ii)

Performance was slightly better in this part. Most candidates recognised that they needed to add the volumes of water in both bottles, and many approached this correctly. However, some were unable to reach the final correct answer due to arithmetic slips or difficulties in converting their results into millilitres, as required by the question. Despite these issues, candidates generally demonstrated greater confidence and accuracy here, suggesting that the skills assessed in this part were more accessible than those required in part b(i).

(Ans: 1500)

Question 43

The table below shows the number of cupcakes sold by a bakery during a week.

	Number of cupcakes sold
Monday	14
Tuesday	17
Wednesday	19
Thursday	15
Friday	11
Saturday	Twice as many as on Sunday
Sunday	

(a) Find the **total** number of cupcakes sold from Monday to Friday.

(b) The average number of cupcakes sold for the week is 16.
Find the number of cupcakes sold on Sunday.

(c)  represents 4 cupcakes.

Use the table below to draw a pictogram to illustrate the number of cupcakes sold on Tuesday.

Tuesday					
---------	--	--	--	--	--

Part (a)

Mostly well attempted by most candidates. A few candidates could earn only partial mark resulting from arithmetic slips. (*Ans: 76*)

Part (b)

This multi-step problem proved challenging for most candidates. While some managed to secure partial credit, a significant number struggled with the initial step, which required calculating the total number of cupcakes sold during the week using the given average. This foundational difficulty often prevented candidates from progressing successfully through the remainder of the problem.

Even among those who identified the correct strategy, many arithmetic slips were noted. These errors undermined otherwise sound approaches and highlight the need for greater accuracy and care in numerical working. The combination of average and ratio concepts demanded careful reasoning and sustained precision across multiple steps, which many candidates found difficult to maintain.

Educators are advised to:

- reinforce the concept of average as $\text{total} \div \text{number of items}$, ensuring candidates can confidently move between totals and averages.
- provide more practice with multi-step problems involving ratios will help candidates sustain logical reasoning across several stages.

On the other hand, candidates should be encouraged to check their arithmetic carefully, perhaps by estimating or reworking key calculations, to reduce the impact of slips on otherwise correct strategies. (Ans: 12)

Part (c)

In this part, candidates were expected to draw a pictogram for the number of cupcakes sold on Tuesday using the given key. This was not well answered by many candidates. The major difficulty laid in representing a fractional part of the picture: for 17 cupcakes, candidates needed to draw four complete circles and a quarter circle. Many struggled with this requirement, either omitting the fractional part or attempting an inaccurate representation. This suggests limited familiarity with pictograms that involve non-whole symbols. While candidates can generally interpret a pictogram with ease, drawing one proved more challenging, particularly when fractional symbols were required.

Educators are advised to:

- Offer targeted practice with pictograms that require fractional or partial symbols, helping candidates become comfortable with accurate representation.
- Stress the importance of interpreting the key correctly and translating numerical values into the appropriate number of symbols, ensuring clarity and precision in data presentation.

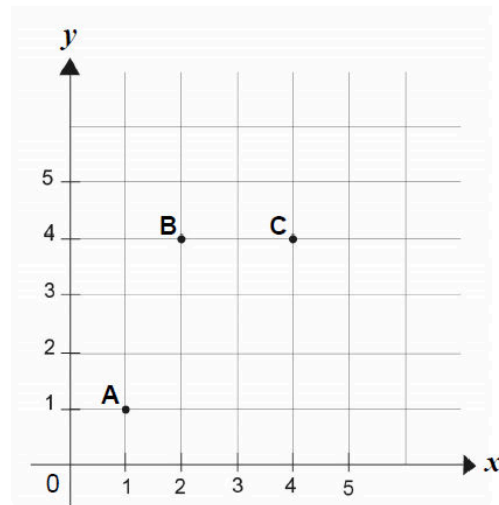
(Ans:

Tuesday	⊕	⊕	⊕	⊕	⊐
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)

Question 44

The graph below shows the points **A**, **B** and **C**.



- (a) State the coordinates of **A**.

Answer: A (..... ,)

- (b) On the graph, plot and label point **D** such that **ABCD** is a parallelogram.
- (c) Find the area of parallelogram **ABCD**.

Part (a):

Performance in this part was good for most candidates. They were able to read the coordinates of point A correctly.

(Answer: (1,1)).

Part (b):

Plotting point D so that diagram ABCD formed a parallelogram was problematic for many candidates. Errors suggest confusion between the properties of a parallelogram and those of a trapezium, with several candidates misplacing point D accordingly.

Part (c):

Very few candidates were able to calculate the area of the parallelogram correctly. The most common method attempted was by counting squares, which often led to inaccurate or incomplete solutions while other chose to calculate the area using formulae.

(Ans: 6).

Question 45

Ella buys 10 apples and 6 bananas for Rs 210.

Noel buys 3 apples and 2 bananas at Rs 65.

Find the cost of 1 banana.

This problem proved to be very challenging for most candidates. Only 2 candidates out of 10 successfully reached the final answer.

Although it could be solved through logical reasoning and step-by-step arithmetic, many struggled to organise their work effectively. A common difficulty was recognising that the question involved two different purchases which needed to be compared in order to isolate the cost of one item. Candidates often treated the information separately rather than linking the two situations. Arithmetic slips were frequent, and some candidates resorted to guessing or trial-and-error rather than applying a structured approach. The requirement to find the cost of a single banana was therefore missed by many, showing that candidates need more practice in handling word problems that combine totals and unit costs without relying on formal algebraic methods.

Educators are advised to:

- emphasise the unitary method (finding the cost of one item before scaling up or down) as a practical alternative to algebra.
- Provide practice with step-by-step reasoning problems, where candidates must compare two purchases and deduce the missing value.
- Encourage candidates to check arithmetic carefully, using estimation or reworking calculations to avoid slips.
- Use real-life contexts (shopping, sharing costs, recipes) to make such problems more relatable and to strengthen logical reasoning without formal algebra.
- Reinforce the importance of linking information across different parts of a problem, rather than treating each statement in isolation. (*Ans:10*)

Conclusions

In conclusion, candidate performance on the 2025 assessment was mixed, demonstrating competence in direct application of basic skills but significant difficulty in tasks requiring reasoning, multi-step processing, and logical thinking. A lack of foundational knowledge, such as multiplication table fluency, and difficulties with English language comprehension continue to be major barriers to success. Furthermore, the lack of clear presentation of working steps often prevents candidates from earning partial credit on complex problems. To improve future outcomes, it is recommended that educators focus on developing reasoning skills through non-routine problems, emphasize the interpretation of real-life contexts, and provide targeted support for mathematical language and communication. By addressing these core challenges, learners will be better prepared to achieve the standards expected at the end of primary education.